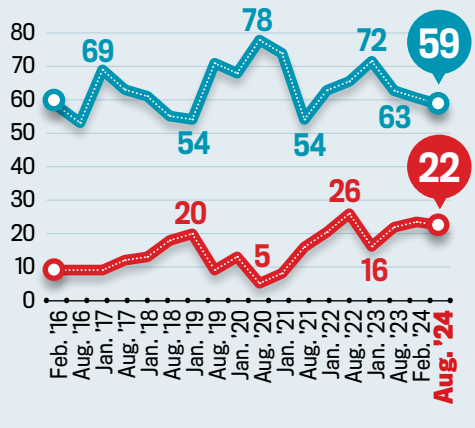
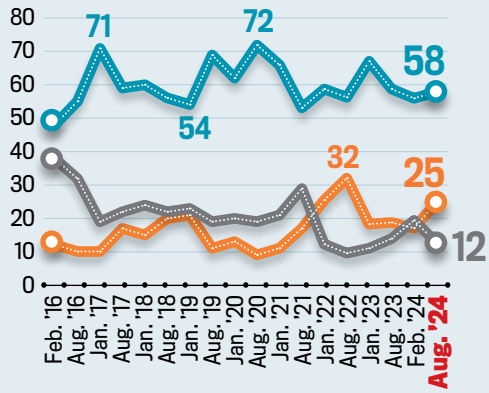
PM MODI'S PERFORMANCE ACROSS MOTN POLLS



All figures in % and rounded off; rest, DK/ CS

Approval of Modi's performance as outstanding or good has been declining since January last year

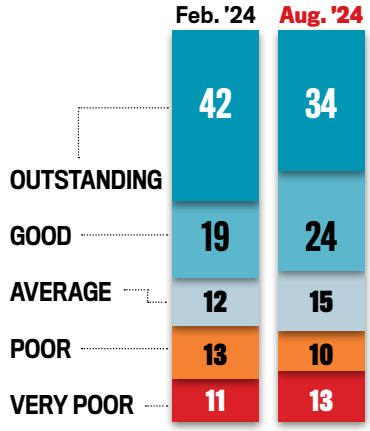
Q. How satisfied are you with the overall performance of the NDA government?



All figures in % and rounded off; rest, DK/ CS

There's been a slight rise in public satisfaction with the NDA govt's overall performance since Feb.

Q. How do you rate the performance of Narendra Modi as prime minister?



All figures in % and rounded off; rest, DK/ CS

40 PER CENT
of the respondents in urban areas rated PM Modi's performance as outstanding compared to 32% in rural areas

46 PER CENT
upper caste Hindu and 41 per cent OBC respondents think so too, the highest among all caste groups

30 PER CENT
Scheduled Caste respondents concur, the lowest among all caste groups

to make more inroads.

What explains the tepid response of the respondents towards the BJP and the NDA despite Modi's popularity remaining high and the voters still relying on him to deliver? The MOTN does, in fact, set the priority for Modi 3.0 and it is clearly economic. That's because, according to the survey, the NDA's three big achievements—constructing the Ram temple in Ayodhya, revocation of Article 370 in Kashmir and the several welfare schemes—seem to have reached an expiry date in terms of electoral returns. By contrast, the Modi government's three biggest failures all pertain to the economy, with unemployment topping the list, followed by price rise and lack of economic growth. Other findings reiterate this fact. Asked what the biggest problem in the country is, 28.5 per cent say it is unemployment, which is three percentage points higher than in the February MOTN. Inflation is the No. 2 concern, followed by poor family incomes.

With 78.2 per cent saying the unemployment situation in the country has turned serious, it flies in the face of the Modi government's assertions that it has added 80 million jobs in the past three years alone. In fact, a majority polled do not believe the government's claim. Worse, over 60 per cent believe that

Modi will have to heed economic concerns as polls in Haryana and Maharashtra loom. Losses here could erode the PM's cult-like status